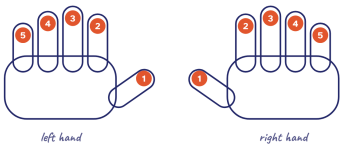
PLAYING AND LISTENING · FINGERING · LEARN




# Fingering

**REMEMBER** Thumbs are 1 in both hands, little fingers 5.

## 1 Finger numbers ★☆☆

Write the number. The first is done.

| FINGER | NUMBER |
|---|---|
| thumb | 1 |
| index finger | |
| middle finger | |
| ring finger | |
| little finger | |

## 2 Five-finger position ★☆☆

Right-hand thumb on C, left-hand little finger on C: write the finger for each note. The first is done.

| | C | D | E | F | G |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **right hand** | 1 | | | | |
| **left hand** | | | | | |

## 3 C major, right hand ★★☆

Write the fingering going up. The first three are done.

| | C | D | E | F | G | A | B | C |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **finger** | 1 | 2 | 3 | | | | | |

## 4 Play it ★☆☆

Play C D E F G up and down with each hand, saying the finger numbers. Tick a circle each day.

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · FINGERING · USE

# Fingering

**REMEMBER** Going up the right hand, the thumb passes under; coming down, finger 3 crosses over.

## 1 Under or over?

★★☆

Circle what happens. The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **right hand going up, after finger 3** | **thumb under** · **finger over** |
| **right hand coming down, after the thumb** | **thumb under** · **finger over** |
| **left hand going up, after the thumb** | **thumb under** · **finger over** |
| **left hand coming down, after finger 3** | **thumb under** · **finger over** |

## 2 C major, left hand

★★☆

Write the fingering going up. The first is done.

| | C | D | E | F | G | A | B | C |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **finger** | 5 | | | | | | | |

## 3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| The thumb is 1 only in the right hand. | T F |
| Write your fingering in once and keep it. | T F |
| The thumb should land heavily as it passes under. | T F |

## 4 Play it

★☆☆

Play the C major scale, one octave, each hand alone. Tick a circle each clean day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

## 5 Explain it

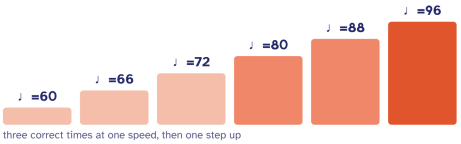
★★☆

Explain why it helps to write your fingering in and keep it.

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PRACTISING WELL · LEARN

# Practising well




**REMEMBER** Slow, small and correct; three correct times, then one notch faster.

## 1 The metronome ladder ★☆☆

The Handbook's ladder (p. 162) goes 60 66 72 80 88 96. Write the two missing steps. The first is done.

60 66 72 **80** ☐

## 2 Good habit? ★☆☆

Circle helps or wastes time. The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **the hardest bar first** | **helps** · **wastes time** |
| **always from the top** | **helps** · **wastes time** |
| **faster to fix a slip** | **helps** · **wastes time** |
| **three correct, then faster** | **helps** · **wastes time** |
| **hands separately first** | **helps** · **wastes time** |

## 3 My fifteen minutes ★★☆

Plan your practice: what will you do in each part?

| TIME | WHAT |
|---|---|
| 2 min · warm up | |
| 5 min · hardest bars | |
| 5 min · join them | |
| 3 min · play it through | |

## 4 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| Small chunks are easier to fix. | **T** **F** |
| Practise only what you can already play. | **T** **F** |
| Hands separately first, then together. | **T** **F** |

## 5 Play it ★☆☆

Choose one hard bar and climb the metronome ladder. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PRACTISING WELL · USE

# Practising well

**REMEMBER** Write it down: what got better, and what to start with tomorrow.

## 1 Practice log ★★☆

Fill in a line after each practice.

| DAY | GOT BETTER | START WITH TOMORROW |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

## 2 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Playing fast and wrong teaches the wrong notes. | T | F |
| One long practice beats several short ones. | T | F |
| Count aloud to keep the rhythm honest. | T | F |

## 3 Chunk it ★★☆

Choose a piece. Write the bars you will practise first, the hardest first.

Bars ☐ to ☐ , then ☐ to ☐

## 4 Play it ★☆☆

Practise for fifteen minutes with your plan from page 3. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

## 5 Explain it ★★☆

Explain why slow and correct is faster than fast and wrong.

Date _____
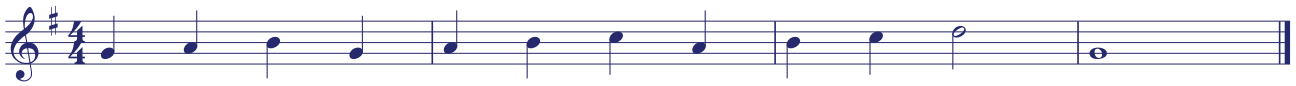
PLAYING AND LISTENING · SIGHT-READING · LEARN

# Sight-reading

**REMEMBER** Thirty seconds of looking, then keep the beat going whatever happens.

## 1 Scan this ★★☆

Look at the music for thirty seconds and complete the sentences. The first is done.



Key: [ G ] major. Time: [ ] beats in a bar.

First note: [ ] . Bar 2 is bar 1 one step [ ] .

## 2 Scan order ★☆☆

Number the checks in the order of the scan. The first is done.

| CHECK | ORDER |
|---|---|
| key | 1 |
| time | [ ] |
| first notes | [ ] |
| rhythm | [ ] |
| patterns | [ ] |
| marks | [ ] |

## 3 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| Stop and fix every wrong note. | T F |
| Choose a speed you can keep. | T F |
| Read shapes, not single notes. | T F |

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · SIGHT-READING · USE
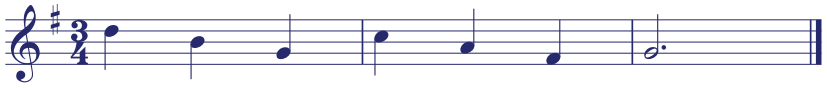
# Sight-reading

**REMEMBER** Look one bar ahead while you play.

## 1 Scan this too

★★☆

Look at the music and complete the sentences. The first is done.



Key: [ G ] major. Time: [ ] beats in a bar.

The F in bar 2 is played as [ ] .

## 2 Sight-reading log

★★☆

One new piece each day: scan, play once without stopping, then tick.

| PIECE | SCANNED | NO STOPS |
|---|---|---|
| | ☐ | ☐ |
| | ☐ | ☐ |
| | ☐ | ☐ |
| | ☐ | ☐ |
| | ☐ | ☐ |

## 3 Read ahead

★☆☆

Cover each bar with a card as you play it. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

## 4 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| A stop is heard more than a wrong note. | T F |
| Look down at your hands while sight-reading. | T F |
| Tap the trickiest rhythm before you start. | T F |

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · LISTENING · LEARN

# Listening




**REMEMBER** Major sounds bright, minor darker: only the middle note of the chord moves.

## 1 Intervals by song ★☆☆

Write a song that has each interval near its start. The first is done.

| INTERVAL | SONG |
|---|---|
| perfect 5th | **Twinkle (2nd to 3rd note)** |
| major 2nd | |
| major 3rd | |
| perfect 4th | |
| octave | |

## 2 Finished or not? ★★☆

In C major: does the ending sound finished? The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **G → C** | **finished** · **not finished** |
| **C → G** | **finished** · **not finished** |
| **F → C** | **finished** · **not finished** |
| **Dm → G** | **finished** · **not finished** |

## 3 Bright or dark? ★☆☆

Play each chord and circle what you hear. The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **C E G** | **bright** · **dark** |
| **C E♭ G** | **bright** · **dark** |
| **A C E** | **bright** · **dark** |
| **G B D** | **bright** · **dark** |

## 4 Play it ★☆☆

Play C E G and C E♭ G one after the other, then sing the middle note of each. Tick a circle each day.

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · LISTENING · USE

# Listening

**REMEMBER** If you can sing it back, you can play it.

## 1 Clap it back

★☆☆

A friend claps two bars; you clap them back. Tick each one you get right first time.

**rhythm 1** ○ **rhythm 2** ○

**rhythm 3** ○ **rhythm 4** ○

## 2 How many beats?

★★☆

Listen to four pieces. Clap along and write the beats in a bar.

| PIECE | BEATS |
|---|---|
| | ☐ |
| | ☐ |
| | ☐ |
| | ☐ |

## 3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| Major and minor chords differ by the middle note. | T F |
| A perfect cadence sounds unfinished. | T F |
| Close your eyes to listen better. | T F |

## 4 Sing it back

★☆☆

A friend plays five notes; you sing them, then find them on the keys. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

## 5 Explain it

★★☆

Explain how you can hear whether a chord is major or minor.

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PERFORMING · LEARN

# Performing




**REMEMBER** Breathe, feel a bar of the beat, then begin. After a slip, catch the next beat.

## 1 The routine

Number the steps in order. The first is done.

| STEP | ORDER |
|---|---|
| adjust the bench | 1 |
| breathe out slowly | |
| feel one bar of the beat | |
| play the first note | |
| stand and bow | |

## 2 After a slip

Circle helps or does not help. The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **keep the beat going** | helps · does not help |
| **go back and fix it** | helps · does not help |
| **rejoin at the next phrase** | helps · does not help |
| **stop and say sorry** | helps · does not help |

## 3 True or false?

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| Nerves mean you care. | T F |
| Practise starting from three places. | T F |
| The audience wants you to fail. | T F |

## 4 Play it

A one-minute concert: walk to the piano, sit, breathe, feel a bar, play eight bars, bow. Tick a circle each day.

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PERFORMING · USE

# Performing

**REMEMBER** Play it once a day without stopping, as if someone were listening.

## 1 My concert plan

★★☆

Write your piece and three places you can start from.

| | |
|---|---|
| piece | |
| start 1 (bar) | |
| start 2 (bar) | |
| start 3 (bar) | |

## 2 Run-throughs

★☆☆

Play it through once a day without stopping. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

## 3 After the concert

★★☆

Write one thing that went well and one thing to practise next.

Went well

Practise next

## 4 Explain it

★★☆

Explain what you will do if you slip in the middle of your piece.

Date

PLAYING AND LISTENING · REVIEW

# Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 13.

## 1 Name it

★☆☆

Write the answer.

| | |
|---|---|
| the finger number of the thumb | |
| the finger for G, right hand, thumb on C | |
| the step after ♩ = 72 on the ladder | |
| a song that starts with a perfect 4th | |

## 2 Complete it

★★☆

One word in each space.

Practise the ____ bar first.

Before sight-reading, look at the key and the ____ signature.

After a slip, keep the ____ going.

## 3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| Going up, the right thumb passes under. | T F |
| Minor chords usually sound brighter than major. | T F |
| Speed up only after three correct times. | T F |

Score ____ / 10

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · PROGRESS

# My progress

**HOW TO USE** Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

| CONCEPT | I KNOW IT | I CAN WRITE IT | I CAN PLAY IT | HANDBOOK |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| finger numbers | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 160 |
| scale fingering | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 160 |
| a practice plan | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 162 |
| the metronome ladder | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 162 |
| the thirty-second scan | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 164 |
| intervals by song | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 166 |
| major or minor by ear | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 166 |
| a performance routine | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 168 |

**Teacher's note**

Date _____

PLAYING AND LISTENING · ANSWERS

# Answers

| PAGE | ANSWERS |
|---|---|
| p. 1 | Numbers: 2, 3, 4, 5. Five-finger: right 1 2 3 4 5 · left 5 4 3 2 1. C major up: 1 2 3 1 2 3 4 5. |
| p. 2 | Under or over: thumb under, finger over, finger over, thumb under. Left hand up: 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1. T/F: F, T, F. |
| p. 3 | Ladder: 80, 88. Habits: helps, wastes time, wastes time, helps, helps. T/F: T, F, T. |
| p. 4 | T/F: T, F, T. |
| p. 5 | Scan: G major, 4 beats; G; up. Order: key 1, time 2, first notes 3, rhythm 4, patterns 5, marks 6. T/F: F, T, T. |
| p. 6 | Scan: G major, 3 beats; F♯. T/F: T, F, T. |
| p. 7 | Songs (or any that fit): Frère Jacques · Oh When the Saints · Amazing Grace · Somewhere over the Rainbow. Endings: finished, not finished, finished, not finished. Bright/dark: bright, dark, dark, bright. |
| p. 8 | T/F: T, F, T. |
| p. 9 | Routine: breathe 2, beat 3, first note 4, bow 5. After a slip: helps, does not help, helps, does not help. T/F: T, T, F. |
| p. 11 | 1 · 5 · 80 · Amazing Grace. hardest; time; beat. T, F, T. |

“Play it”, “in your music”, listening and playing have no single answer to copy: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____